

Trump Urges Calls to Cotton in Push for Permanent Daylight Saving Time

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On Saturday, October 3, President Donald Trump urged Americans to contact Arkansas Senator Tom Cotton to support a bill making daylight saving time **permanent**. Cotton repeated his opposition, bringing renewed attention to a policy question that affects school travel and the timing of daylight.

During daylight saving time, clocks in most parts of the United States are set one hour ahead of standard time from spring to fall. The current system generally involves changing clocks twice a year. Not every state observes daylight saving time.

The Sunshine Protection Act passed the House of Representatives in July, but opposition in the Senate remains an obstacle. Passage in one **chamber** of Congress does not mean a proposal has become law. Under this bill, states could **opt out** if their **legislatures** acted before its **enactment**.

Supporters, including the White House, argue that keeping daylight saving time would provide more daylight during hours when Americans are most active. Trump has emphasized the inconvenience of adjusting clocks and the value of evening daylight for activities such as golf and tennis.

Opponents focus on winter mornings. Keeping clocks ahead throughout the year would produce later sunrises by the clock. Cotton says this could leave children traveling to school in darkness. Other critics raise concerns about children waiting for school buses and parents driving to work.

Trump blamed Cotton for blocking the proposal. Cotton repeated his position in a social media post. He said Congress had previously tried **permanent** daylight saving time and later reversed course after Americans experienced late winter sunrises. He is among several Republican senators opposing the change.

A 2025 Associated Press-NORC poll found that 12 percent of American adults favored the current clock-changing system, 47 percent opposed it and 40 percent were **neutral**. If required to choose, most preferred keeping the extra hour of evening daylight.

The debate asks lawmakers to weigh convenience and evening activities against the effects of darker winter mornings.

Word Treasure

permanent -- Continuing rather than changing back each season.

chamber -- One of the two parts of Congress: the House or the Senate.

opt out -- Choose not to take part.

legislatures -- Groups of elected lawmakers that make laws.

enactment -- The process of making a proposal into law.

neutral -- Neither supporting nor opposing something.

Background you need

Daylight saving time sets clocks one hour ahead of standard time.

Passing one chamber of Congress does not make a bill law.

The proposed state opt-out would require action before enactment.

Break it down

Introduces Trump's October 3 request and Cotton's response.

Defines daylight saving time and explains the bill's status.

Presents arguments about evening daylight and winter school travel.

Attributes Cotton's account of earlier attempts and reports poll findings.

Closes with the choices lawmakers are weighing.

Why it matters

A permanent clock setting would affect the timing of daylight for school travel, work trips and evening activities.

Test what you remember

1. What did Trump urge Americans to do on October 3?
 - (A) Ask Cotton to change school hours
 - (B) Ask Cotton to support the bill
 - (C) Ask Cotton to withdraw the bill
 - (D) Ask Cotton to rewrite the poll
2. Which statement describes the bill's progress?
 - (A) It passed both chambers but awaits state votes.
 - (B) It passed state legislatures but awaits House votes.
 - (C) It passed the Senate but faces House opposition.
 - (D) It passed the House but faces Senate opposition.
3. When could state legislatures act to opt out under the bill?
 - (A) Before the bill's enactment
 - (B) After the first winter under the change
 - (C) After the next national opinion poll
 - (D) Before each spring clock change
4. Which activities does Trump mention when discussing evening daylight?
 - (A) Golf and tennis
 - (B) Baseball and running
 - (C) Hiking and fishing
 - (D) Swimming and cycling
5. What did Cotton say about earlier attempts at permanent daylight saving time?
 - (A) Congress kept the policy after reviewing evening activities.
 - (B) Congress expanded the policy after earlier winter sunrises.
 - (C) Congress delayed the policy after changing school schedules.
 - (D) Congress reversed course after late winter sunrises.
6. According to the 2025 poll, which share opposed the current clock-changing system?
 - (A) Most of the Republican senators
 - (B) 12 percent of American adults
 - (C) 40 percent of American adults
 - (D) 47 percent of American adults

Answer key (try the quiz first!): 1: B 2: D 3: A 4: A 5: D 6: D

Questions to think about

1. Donald Trump: Supports permanent daylight saving time, emphasizing the inconvenience of changing clocks and evening daylight for golf and tennis.
2. Tom Cotton: Opposes permanent daylight saving time because of late winter sunrises and children traveling to school in darkness.

MY THOUGHTS (at least 20 words):